

Help me understand. Why do AI haters that argue AI displaces water from areas not realize that major AI companies used closed-loop water systems anyway?

Posted by u/RevolutionaryDark818 • 0 points • 2 comments

I always see this argument everywhere that it displaces water from areas (evaporated water doesn't always come back to the same spot), but they always forget to account that these major companies that use water cooling use closed-loop water systems meaning the water is recycled back into the database after use to cool the database again.

Comments

u/ProtozoaPatriot • 1 points • 2025-10-22 14:32 UTC

They still need water incoming each day.

Closed loop systems pump the heat outside of the building to a heat exchanger. Unless the outside air is pretty cold, the better way to remove heat is to run water over it (evaporative cooling). That's where the incoming water goes.

Source: Substack <https://share.google/g80SwhRmFamZJY8Mv>

"Larger data centers can each "drink" up to 5 million gallons per day, or about 1.8 billion annually, "
<https://www.eesi.org/articles/view/data-centers-and-water-consumption>

"a mid-sized data center consumes around 300,000 gallons of water a day, or about as much as 1,000 U.S. households,"

<https://www.npr.org/2022/08/30/1119938708/data-centers-backbone-of-the-digital-economy-face-water-scarcity-and-climate-ris>

u/papuan • 3 points • 2025-10-22 13:46 UTC

Many don't used closed-loop systems.